

SAMPLE REPORT — FOR INTERNAL REVIEW ONLY. Zones, names, and content below are illustrative, built to demonstrate report format and content, not a real verified engagement.



Title. Taxes. HOA health. Permits. Neighborhood reality. Local know-how. All verified, all in one report.

AREA EDITION

Neighborhood & Access Comparison, No Property Address Required

Zones Covered (sample)	Santa Ana and Atenas, San José Province
Report Tier	Area Edition
Engagement Reference	TR-2026-0002-SAMPLE
Prepared For	[Client Name]
Prepared By	Jota Properties CR — THE REPORT
Date Delivered	August 28, 2026

1. Summary

This report compares two zones for a buyer who hasn't yet chosen a neighborhood, let alone a property. It covers access, character, and the practical realities of daily life in each, plus a set of country-wide notes that apply no matter which zone you choose. No property has been identified yet, so there is no title, tax, HOA, or permit information in this report, if you'd like that on a specific property once you've found one, Records or Full Edition covers it.

This report is not a recommendation of one zone over the other. It's the same honest picture either way, so you can weigh the trade-offs yourself.

2. Neighborhood & Access Dossier — Santa Ana

About Santa Ana

Santa Ana sits directly adjacent to Escazú along the Route 27 corridor and offers a calmer, more residential alternative at a somewhat more accessible price point, though "accessible" is relative, this is still one of the most expensive rental markets in the western Central Valley. The zone isn't a single character: Santa Ana Centro, Pozos, Rio Oro, Valle del Sol, Brasil, and Piedades each read differently, from hillside privacy to condo-and-local-life mixing. Healthcare access improved meaningfully with Hospital Metropolitano's Lindora-area campus and the newer Clínica Bíblica Santa Ana location, residents no longer have to drive into San José for quality private care. Forum 1 and Forum 2 business parks anchor a real corporate and tech presence, which shapes daily life for a portion of residents, hybrid and remote work are common here specifically because commuting during peak traffic is a genuine burden, not a lifestyle preference. The area also mixes in traditional Costa Rican life, a Sunday morning farmers market (Feria del Agricultor) among the longest-running in the Central Valley, alongside its newer condos and country clubs.



Sunset view over the Central Valley from the Santa Ana area

Access

- Drive to Juan Santamaría International Airport (SJO): roughly 30-40 minutes midday, 50-70 minutes during morning or evening rush hour via Route 27
- Primary route runs through the Próspero Fernández corridor, the main traffic chokepoint for this area at peak hours

Proximity

- Approximately 15-20 minutes to Hospital CIMA
- Several bilingual and international schools within a 15-minute drive

Character

- Established expat and upper-income Tico neighborhood, a mix of gated communities and standalone homes
- Active commercial corridor (Forum, Multiplaza) within a short drive, more built-up and less rural than outlying Central Valley towns
- Higher cost of living relative to outlying zones, reflected in both property prices and day-to-day expenses

Current Local Conditions

- No unusual conditions to report in this area at this time (this line is updated per report, not left blank by default)

3. Neighborhood & Access Dossier — Atenas

About Atenas

Atenas is known almost entirely for one claim: "el mejor clima del mundo," the best climate in the world. That specific attribution to National Geographic doesn't hold up to verification, the most thorough tracing of the claim's origin points to a 1990s municipal marketing campaign, the same effort that gave Heredia "City of Flowers" and San Ramón "City of Poets." No one has located an actual National Geographic citation. What is independently verifiable: data from Costa Rica's National Meteorological Institute puts Atenas at roughly 2,500 sunshine hours a year, about seven hours a day on average, compared with San José's 5.2, and daytime temperatures typically in the mid-70s to mid-80s Fahrenheit with cooler nights, a genuine product of its elevation (roughly 2,200-4,000 feet) sitting where Pacific moisture meets the Central Valley's ridgeline. Atenas has an unusually pleasant, well-documented climate; whether it is literally "the world's best" is a slogan, not a finding. Atenas is the second-most foreign-populated town in Costa Rica behind Escazú, with real estate and daily costs running noticeably below the western corridor zones, and a large share of American and Canadian retirees specifically.



Atenas town landmark sign



Aerial view of Atenas town center

Access

- Drive to SJO: roughly 45-60 minutes midday, 60-80 minutes during rush hour, via Route 27 and Route 3
- Fewer route alternatives than Santa Ana, if the main road has an incident, there isn't a convenient detour

Proximity

- Closest full-service hospital is roughly 30-40 minutes away, in Alajuela or San José, longer than Santa Ana's options
- Fewer international school options locally, some families commute toward Alajuela or Santa Ana for schooling

Character

- Smaller town feel, popular with retirees for climate and a lower cost of living relative to the Escazú/Santa Ana corridor
- Known locally for a mild, dry microclimate, often cited as a draw for this specific area
- Less built-up commercially, day-to-day errands often mean a drive rather than a walk

Current Local Conditions

- No unusual conditions to report in this area at this time (this line is updated per report, not left blank by default)

4. Practical Systems Notes

The following applies regardless of which zone you choose, these are country-wide realities, not specific to Santa Ana or Atenas.

Mobile Phone Service

Costa Rica has three carriers: Kölbi (state-run), Liberty (formerly Movistar), and Claro. All three sell prepaid SIMs that require only a valid passport to register, no Costa Rican residency needed, which covers what most visiting or newly arrived buyers need. Kölbi is the one carrier with an explicitly branded tourist product (marketed as the SIM Turista); Claro and Liberty's standard prepaid plans are equally open to visitors, they're just not marketed under a separate tourist-specific name. The better-value postpaid contract plans, across all three carriers, require legal residency (a DIMEX or cédula card) and a credit check, so none of them are an option until residency is established. Confirm current plans, prices, and registration requirements directly with the carrier, offerings change.

Driving Legally as a Foreign Visitor, and Renting a Car

Since a 2024 reform to Article 91 of Costa Rica's Transit Law, a valid foreign driver's license is recognized for the same length of time as your authorized legal stay in the country, up to a maximum of 180 days for visitors from the US, Canada, and most of Europe. Before this reform, foreign licenses were capped at 90 days no matter how long the stay was authorized. The actual number of days you're granted at entry is set by the immigration officer, not automatically the maximum, and it's tied to the stamp in your passport, not your rental agreement or how long you personally plan to stay. You're required to show proof of onward or return travel to enter the country, but a near-term return ticket doesn't necessarily limit the number of days granted, that's still at the officer's discretion. Whatever date is stamped in your passport is also your deadline to exit. Driving past that date on a foreign license carries real penalties, a fine and the transit police can confiscate the vehicle's plates. Confirm the exact date stamped in your own passport rather than assuming the maximum, and note that immigration rules can change.

Rental Car Pricing and Booking

Some rental agencies quote in colones so the number looks smaller than the USD equivalent, and mandatory insurance is often left off the advertised rate until you're at the counter. Booking through an online rental aggregator or booking agency rather than reserving directly typically locks in the full rate, insurance included, before you arrive, and often reduces the security deposit required at pickup. Either way, confirm the all-in USD total, including required insurance, before signing anything.

Banking as a Foreigner

A tourist or non-resident can open a simplified personal account at some Costa Rican banks, Banco de Costa Rica and Banco Nacional are the two most commonly cited, using just a passport, no cédula or DIMEX required. These simplified accounts carry a monthly deposit cap. Sources vary: most put it around \$1,000-\$1,500, some report limits as high as the equivalent of \$2,000-\$6,000 depending on the bank and branch, and exceeding the cap can freeze the account. Non-residents generally can't access SINPE, Costa Rica's national electronic payment system used for many local transfers, since that requires a cédula or DIMEX. Full-service accounts with higher limits and broader features typically require legal residency. Confirm the current cap directly with the bank, limits vary by institution and change.

Weather and the Rainy Season

Costa Rica runs on two seasons rather than four: a dry season roughly December through April, and a rainy season (locally, invierno) roughly May through November. In the Central Valley specifically, the pattern tends to be dry, sunny mornings even deep into the rainy season, with showers arriving in the afternoon and clearing by evening. As of the Instituto Meteorológico Nacional's April 2026 seasonal outlook, 2026 itself is running against the usual pattern: rainfall for the second half of the year is projected at 10-30% below normal, with the largest shortfalls expected September through November, alongside a hotter-than-average

year overall. Seasonal forecasts shift as the year goes on and vary zone to zone within the Central Valley's own microclimates, confirm the current outlook rather than assume this pattern repeats in a future year.

Home Internet Service

The Central Valley is the best-served part of the country for home internet, with several providers offering overlapping coverage: Kölbi (the state-run ICE brand), Liberty (formerly Cabletica, and before that Movistar), Claro, and Tigo. Fiber is widely available in urban and suburban Central Valley zones specifically, with advertised speeds commonly running from the mid-double digits up to 300-500 Mbps, and some fiber plans reaching up to 1 Gbps. Where fiber hasn't reached a specific address, cable or DSL plans are typically still available, and Starlink satellite service is now a genuine option for anywhere still underserved. Availability and actual speed vary block to block even within a well-served zone, confirm what's actually installable at a specific address.

Healthcare: CAJA and Private Care

Costa Rica runs a two-track healthcare system. CAJA (formally CCSS) is the mandatory public system for legal residents, funded through a monthly contribution of roughly 7-11% of declared income. It covers pre-existing conditions from day one, but non-emergency and elective procedures can carry real wait times. Public hospital emergency rooms treat everyone regardless of insurance or residency status; no one is turned away. Alongside CAJA, a private system operates its own hospitals, several of the country's best-known, including CIMA, Clínica Bíblica, and Hospital Metropolitano, are clustered in or near the Central Valley, with 24-hour emergency departments and English-speaking staff, at costs well below equivalent US care. Digital Nomad visa holders are a specific exception: they're exempt from CAJA and instead required to carry private international health insurance as a condition of the visa. Nationwide emergency response is reached by dialing 911.

Mail and Package Delivery

Correos de Costa Rica is the national postal service, and while domestic delivery in urban areas is reasonably dependable, international mail can be slow and unpredictable, commonly weeks, sometimes longer. Many residents use a PO box (apartado postal) or a mail-forwarding address in the US rather than relying on direct international delivery. Every package entering the country from abroad has to clear customs and may incur import duties regardless of declared value. Private couriers (DHL, UPS, FedEx) offer faster, more trackable delivery at a higher cost, still subject to the same customs process.

Traffic and Commute Times

Costa Rica placed second-worst in the world for traffic in Numbeo's 2026 Mid-Year Traffic Index, behind only Nigeria, with an average one-way commute of roughly 60 minutes nationally. San José itself ranked second-worst globally among individual cities, behind only Lagos. Within the Central Valley, congestion is heavily concentrated in the morning (roughly 7-9am) and afternoon (roughly 4-7pm) windows; one government traffic study found San José canton's average speed dropping from about 14 km/h in the morning to 7 km/h in the afternoon, with Santa Ana and Alajuela both showing notable slowdowns of their own. Route 27, the main corridor connecting San José to Santa Ana, Ciudad Colón, and Atenas, is particularly congested, especially on weekends. Test the real commute at rush hour before treating a distance as a fixed travel time.

Utilities: Electricity and Water

Electricity is supplied mainly by ICE, with CNFL serving as a secondary regional provider in parts of the Central Valley. Costa Rica generates over 98% of its power from renewable sources, which keeps the grid clean but not particularly cheap, a typical household bill runs roughly \$50-150 a month. Water is supplied mainly by AyA, with ASADAS (community-run water boards) common in rural areas outside AyA's coverage.

Transferring an existing connection into a new owner's name is generally a straightforward office visit with ID and proof of ownership; a brand-new connection where none existed can take one to three weeks or considerably longer. Both ICE and AyA are known for optimistic timelines that stretch past what's initially quoted.

5. Exhibits

[Map placeholder in this sample. A delivered report includes annotated satellite/Google Maps screenshots for each zone showing routes and points of interest.]

6. Delivery Manifest

Neighborhood & Access content, Santa Ana	Maintained content, last reviewed August 2026 (sample date)
Neighborhood & Access content, Atenas	Maintained content, last reviewed August 2026 (sample date)
Practical Systems Notes	Maintained content, last reviewed August 2026 (sample date)

Disclaimer

We are not a concierge service. Each report is a complete, independent engagement on the property and/or area you request. You're always welcome back, for another property, the same one again down the road, or to stay current between purchases through THE BRIEFING, our optional quarterly update on the areas we cover. Whichever you choose is entirely up to you: we'll never chase a renewal, and the report itself never turns into an ongoing arrangement you didn't ask for.

This report reflects general area knowledge and does not verify any specific property. It is not a legal opinion and does not guarantee that any individual property within these zones is free of issues. If you do not have a Costa Rica real estate attorney, we can refer one.